

Dungeon Danger



Game Design Document

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Story:

A long time ago there was a peaceful village with a holy temple at its center, this temple has been causing chaos in the area.

Since it's been struck by lightning people hear voices when they get near and some people have been reported missing.

In this game you play as someone collectively chosen by the villagers to face the risk head on and save the people he loves.

Game Brief:

In this game your character goes through a dungeon fighting enemies and solving room for room challenges. By solving puzzles and fighting enemies the player can progress through all the rooms and take on the final boss fight.

Target Platforms

The target platforms for this game are:

- PC
- Xbox
- PlayStation
- Switch



Target Audience

The target audience for this game is nostalgic gamers that are familiar with older Zelda's or the Binding of Isaac game.

This game is also a great fit for people unfamiliar with these titles because of the simple mechanics.

The reason to play this game instead is because the gameplay is only revolving around exploring the dungeon and because this game will be supported on different console platforms.

Players:

This game will only have a 3rd person single player mode.

The players health bar will be displayed as a Ui element.

Enemies don't have a visible health bar.



[Player's health bar example]

Objectives:

The win-condition of my game is beating the final boss and obtaining the final item.

To reach this goal the player must move from room to room, beating enemies, obtaining items, finding keys and solving puzzles.

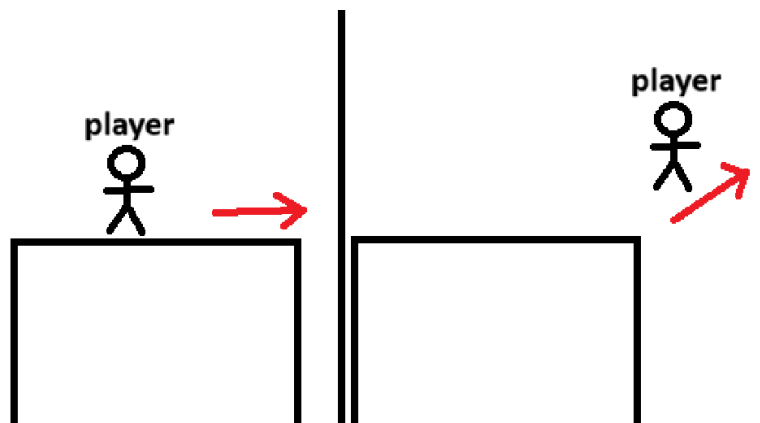
The side objectives are to find secret rooms that reward the player with extra health or other items.

Rules (Mechanics):

Player Mechanics:

- Auto Jump

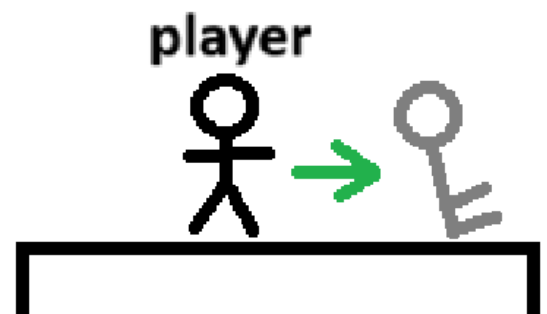
If the player walks up to a ledge and keeps walking the player automatically jumps.



- Use potion

When the player opens his inventory and selects an item, he gets the option to consume it.

- Pickup items



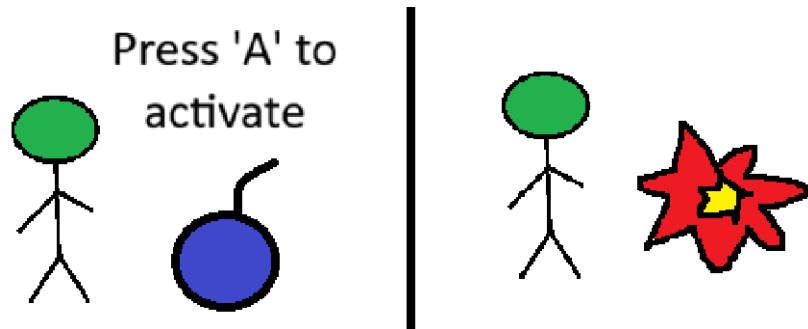
Items can be picked up by the player by directly walking into them, this adds the item to the player inventory. Multiple items can be held at the same time



- Interact

The player can interact with some objects. Example:

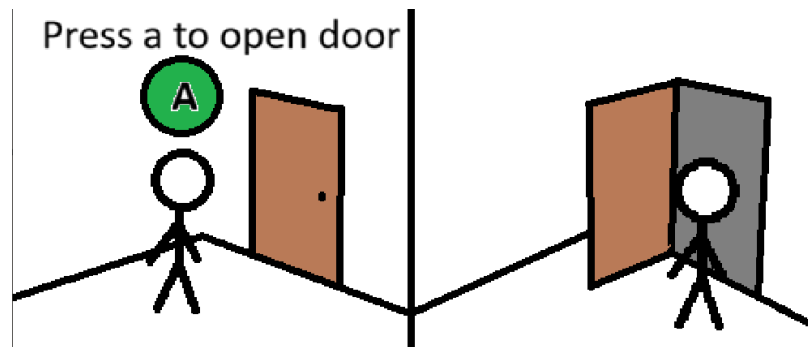
If the player stands next to a bomb and presses the action button – the bomb will explode after a set amount of time.



- Doors / Locked Doors

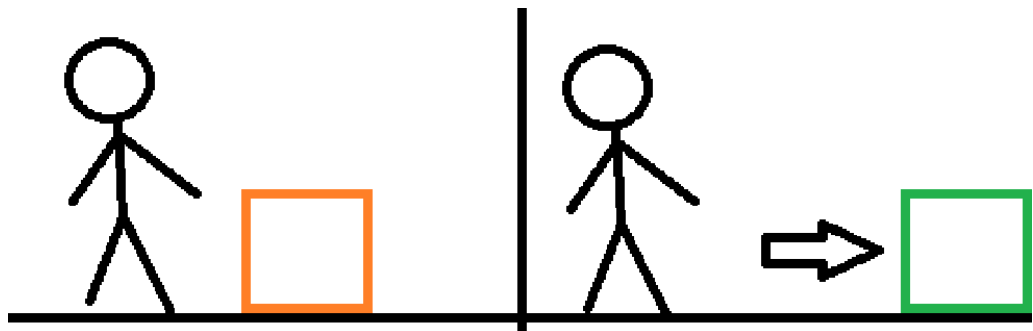
If the player walks up to an unlocked door, he can use the action button to open the door.

If the door is locked and the player has more than 1 key in his inventory, then the lock is removed, the key destroyed and the door opens after pressing the action button.



- Push blocks

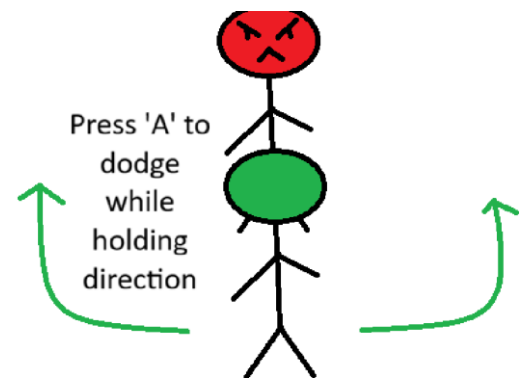
When the player stands next to a moveable block and holds down the action button the block can be pushed in 2 directions (forwards and back).



Combat Mechanics:

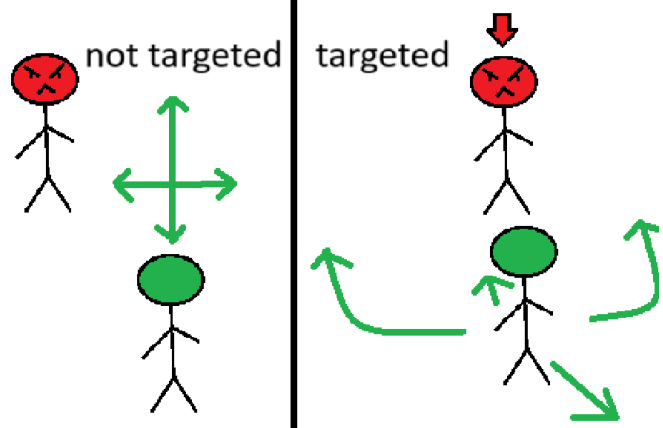
- Dodge

When pressing the dodge button, the player jumps in the current moving direction



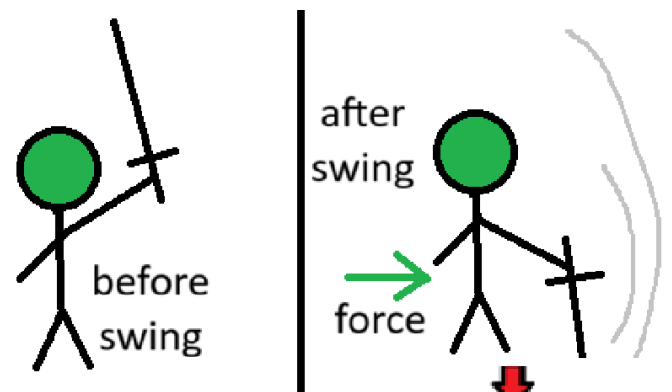
- Lock on enemy:

When the player is in combat with an enemy, he can press the target button to lock the play camera to the enemy.



- Melee Attack

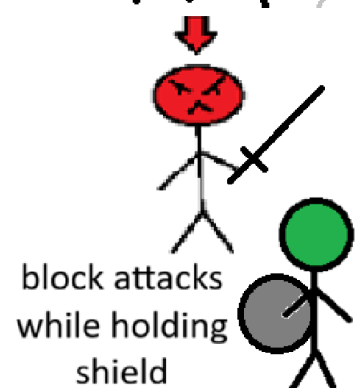
When the player presses the attack button the player swings his weapon which also moves the player forward.



- Shield

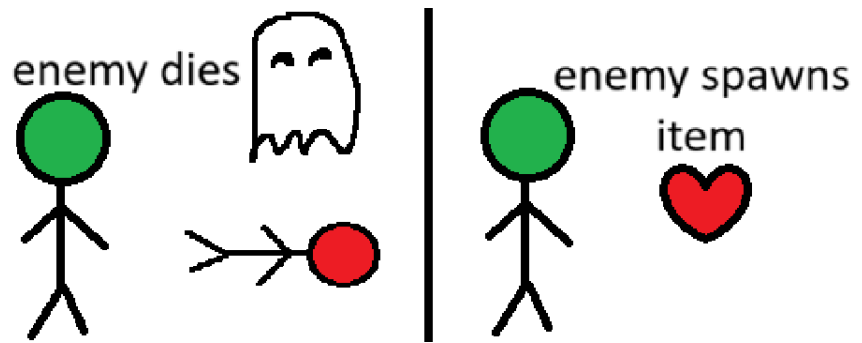
When the player uses the shield button during combat all the incoming damage will be blocked, and player movement speed is slowed down.

Using the shield drains stamina, if the stamina bar is fully depleted the player stops defending.



- Drop items on death.

If an enemy dies it has a chance to drop a health item or a coin.



- Save Progress

If the player finds a save statue, he can insert coins to save his current progression. Each time he finds a new statue it overrides his progress and the cost goes up.

After the player dies, he returns to the last save point and his resources are reset to that point.

Procedures (Dynamics):

Combat Dynamics:

- Dodge and attack.

When the player gets attacked and dodges the attack the player gets the chance to strike while the enemy is not facing him.

- Doors unlock after defeating enemies.

When the player defeats all the enemies in the current room a locked door opens.

- Enemy health bars aren't visible.

Making the health bar invisible causes the player to be unsure of the enemy's remaining health.

This can cause the player to start counting the amount of hits every enemy type takes.

Environment Dynamics:

- Unlock doors

If the player sees a door that can't be unlocked yet he must make a mental map of the environment so that when he obtains a key, he remembers what door to open.

- Solving puzzles

If a player appears to be stuck in a room, he gets forced to read the environment for clues to progress.

Resources:

- Health
- Stamina
- Keys
- Coins

Conflict:

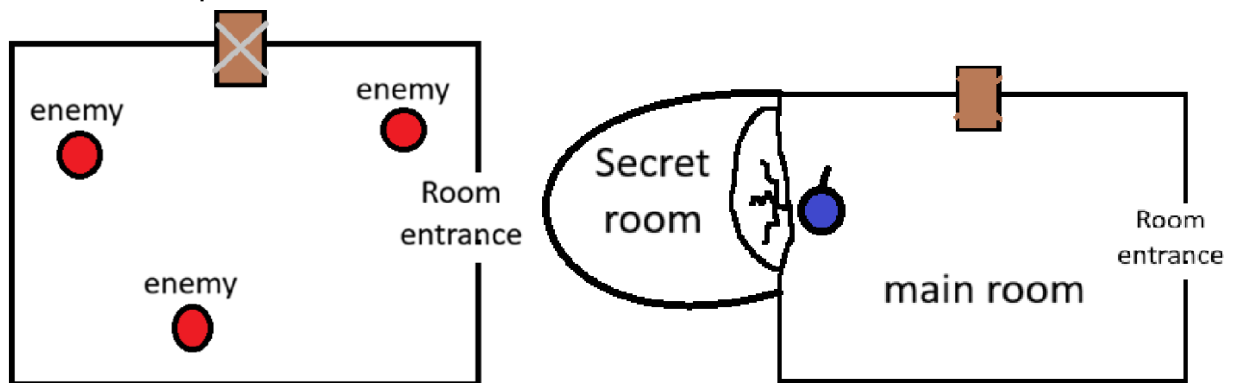
The conflicts that try to stop the player from progressing are:

- Rooms behind locked doors.
- Puzzles that stop the player from progressing.
- Enemies that try to kill the player.

Boundaries:

My game takes place inside a dungeon, this means the rooms are compact and the players don't have a lot of freedom or choice in what order they complete the rooms.

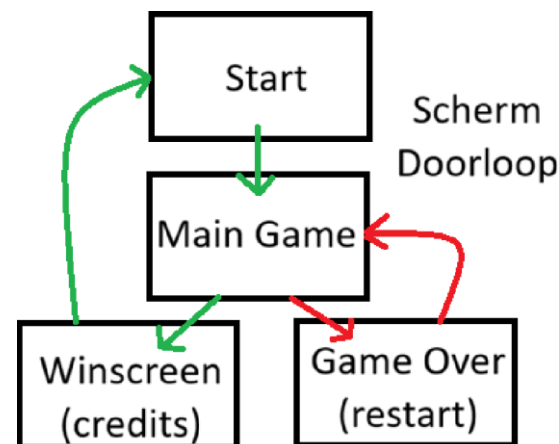
Room examples:



Outcome:

If the player takes too much damage and dies, the game ends, a death screen will be enabled to ask the player if he wants to quit or retry the level from the last save point.

After successfully completing the full game, the player will be sent to a win-screen which includes the game credits.



Enemy Types

- Bat

Behavior:

Bats stay still when spawned and only chase the player when awakened.

Movement:

Once the bats spot the player they move in his direction and start attacking when in range.

Health Amount: Low

Bats die after 1 direct hit.



- Skeleton

Behavior :

If the player is in the same room the skeleton spots it right away.

The skeleton uses a shield and sword to attack and defend against the player.

Movement:

The movement speed is average because the skeleton is wearing / holding heavy gear.

Health Amount – Large



- Archer

Behavior :

If too close the archer tries to walk away from the player.

If the distance is great enough he takes aim and shoots.

Movement:

The movement speed is high because the archer needs to run away from the player.

Health Amount – Mid



- Boss enemy (snake)

Behavior:

The enemy moves in random directions and tries to hit the player, the point of the tail is his weak point.

Movement:

Every time the weak point gets hit the movement speed increases and movement gets less predictable.



Health Amount:

When the weak point gets hit 3 times the enemy dies.

Aesthetics

The aesthetics that the players will experience are:

- Exploring

Throughout the game the player explores different rooms with different win conditions. The player must find out what to do in what room.

- Challenging / Frustrating

If the player is in combat the gameplay can be challenging or frustrating depending on the difficulty of the current enemy or if more than 1 enemy are attacking.

If the player dies and didn't use a save statue it can be challenging to progress back to that point.

Milestone Planning

- Gameloop
 - Time Scale
 - Movement, 3 hours
 - Enemy target system, 5 hours
 - Interaction system, 4 hours
 - Health script, 1 hour
 - Player user interface 2 hours
 - Enemy Health Script 1 hour
 - User interface, 2 hours
 - Playtests, 5 hours
 - Process playtest feedback, 5 hours
 - Tweak feel and gameplay, 3 hours

- Player
 - Time Scale
 - Movement, 3 hours
 - Auto Jump, 2 hours
 - Dodge, 2 hours
 - Shield, 2 hours
 - Enemy target system, 5 hours
 - Interaction system, 4 hours
 - Health script, 1 hour
- Enemies
 - Time Scale
 - Skeleton enemy type, 3 hours
 - Archer enemy type, 2 hours
- Map design
 - Time Scale
 - Design dungeon room layout, 2 hours
 - Puzzle scripts, 4 hours
 - Puzzle design, 2 hours
- Boss fight
 - Time Scale
 - Movement, 3 hours
 - Weakpoints / health logic, 2 hours
 - Health bar user interface, 2 hours
- Interface menu
 - Time Scale
 - Main menu 1 hour
 - Settings 2 hours
 - Pause screen 1 hour
 - Save/load, 3 hours

- Final phase
 - Time Scale
 - Sound effects, 3 hours
 - Add music, 1 hour
 - Add particles, 1 hour
 - Playtests 2, 5 hours
 - Process playtest feedback, 5 hours
 - Polish project, 5 hours